# glu Presentations

PDF slides with Markdown and Lua

Patrick — March 2026

boxes & glue

# Why glu for slides?

- **Markdown** — easy to write
- **Lua** — dynamic and programmable
- **CSS** — full control over layout
- **PDF** — universal output format

> *Less overhead than LaTeX/Beamer, more control than Marp.*

# How it works

A Markdown file with YAML frontmatter:

```
---
title: My Talk
css: slides.css
---
```

Each `## heading` starts a new slide (via CSS `break-before: always`).

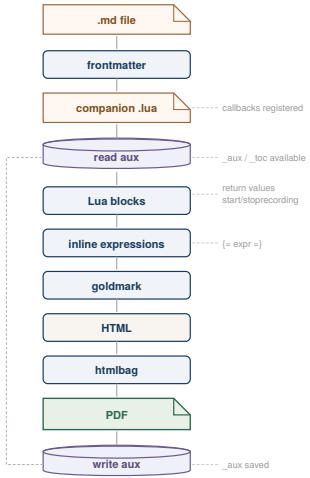
Lua code embedded directly: **4** is four.

# Lua blocks

This talk covers **4** topics:

1. Text formatting
2. Tables and lists
3. SVG graphics
4. Dynamic content

# The Markdown pipeline



# Tables

| Feature | Supported |
|---|---|
| Markdown syntax | Yes |
| CSS styling | Yes |
| Lua logic | Yes |
| SVG graphics | Yes |
| Page numbers | Yes |

# Callbacks for recurring elements

In the companion file `slides.lua`:

- **page_init** — page number, accent line, logo
- **pre_shipout** — final adjustments before rendering
- **document_end** — post-processing

```
frontend.add_callback("page_init", "slide_number",
    function(doc, page, pagenum, pageinfo)
        -- page number in the bottom right
    end)
```

# Lua blocks: syntax

This is what a Lua block looks like in Markdown:

````
```{lua}
-- executed and the result is inserted
items = { "Item 1", "Item 2" }
return "There are " .. #items .. " items."
```
````

Inline expressions with **{= … =}** are replaced directly.

To only **display** code (without executing): **{!lua}** instead of {lua}.

# Verbatim blocks

Want to display code blocks with ``` verbatim? Simply wrap them with more backticks:

````
```{lua}
return "Hello from Lua!"
```
````

The outer 5 backticks protect the inner block — it is **displayed**, not executed.

# Lua blocks: live example

**3** kinds of fruit: Apples, Pears, Cherries

And the same as a non-executed block with {!lua}:

```
example = { "Apples", "Pears", "Cherries" }
return #example .. " kinds of fruit"
```

# Thank you!

Source code: `playground/slides.md`

Back to: Why glu for slides?

Run with:

```
glu slides.md
```